

PAULINE ACHIENG BALA

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PERSONAL PROFILE SUMMARY:

I am a committed and result-oriented Natural Resource & Environmental Governance professional with a focus on Environmental economics, Life cycle assessments of projects and Renewable Energy Technologies, Climate change mitigation and adaptation, Environmental Management systems, Environmental & Social Risk management of development Projects, Forestry and Land restoration. I am an experienced researcher, trainer and consultant with local and international work experience and academic training in East Africa, South America and Europe. My research and training interests aim at informing the formulation of public policy to ultimately empower the most vulnerable communities.

ACADEMIC AND PROFESSIONAL QUALIFICATIONS

2024-Present: Joint PhD researcher /student at the University of Antwerp and KU Leuven, Belgium (PhD in Techno- sustainability assessments of Renewable Energy- Environmental Economics) .

Conducting Sustainability assessments by mapping and evaluating the various options of solar cooking technologies using the Choice Model Experiments, sustainability assessments of the potential environmental impact of New Solar Cooker Technologies.

2014-2015: University of North Wales, Bangor, United Kingdom (MSc. Sustainable tropical Forestry (Environmental Forestry)).

2014-2015 : University of Copenhagen, Denmark (MSc. Sustainable Tropical Forestry- Forest and Livelihood).

2005-2009 : Egerton University- BSc. Natural Resources Management.

SHORT COURSES

July 2023-Sept 2023 (Six Weeks)_ Strategic Leadership Development Program, Kenya School of Government

February 2023-May 2023: Social Impact Assessment, University of Strclyde, UK.

Feb 2023- March 2023: Integrated Environmental Impact Assessments and Audits by University of Nairobi, Wangari Maathai institute.

March 2022-Africa Women Leadership: Online Training Programme.

Dec 2021: Climate change Youth Negotiators African Institute for Economic Development and Planning.

August 2021: September 2021–Short Course (Four Weeks) on Green Growth, Climate Change and Environmental Sustainability by DANIDA Fellowship Program, Denmark

May 2021-Facilitating Online Program by Kenya School of Government E-learning institute

January 2020- Training of Trainers , Kenya School of Government.

January 14th– February 6th, 2019:Senior Management Course in Kenya School of government, Embu Campus.

November –December 2017- National Adaptation Plans: Building climate Resilience in Agriculture (Massive Open Online Course) .

October 2017- Risk based development of Integrated Management Systems of both Quality and Environmental Management Systems Management Systems (ISO 9001: 2015 & ISO 14001:2015).

January-2012-Short course on Report writing in KEFRI.

October 2011-December 2011-Japan International Corporation agency, Yokohama.

SUMMARY OF SKILLS, KNOWLEDGE AND ATTRIBUTES

- Sustainability assessments skills (Life Cycle Assessments and Environmental appraisal techniques using Discrete Choice Experiment)
- Budding skills in data analysis with python and R
- Technical understanding of social safeguards, Participatory process, Climate change, green growth, Climate Finance, Environmental Impacts Assessments, Forestry, social Risk Management, Social Impact Assessments, Climate Risk assessments.
- Analytical Skills
- Excellent coordination skills
- Strong aptitude for learning
- Sound understanding of quantitative and qualitative research skills
- Innovative skills
- Good communication and Interpersonal skills
- Good research and consultancy skills
- Expertise in facilitation and co-ordination of workshops
- Ability to work with minimal supervision.

EXPERIENCE IN EMPLOYMENT:

Current Employer: Kenya School of Government (KSG)

Present Post - 2018 to Date: Senior Research Fellow

Workstation: Lower Kabete

Current Duties and Responsibilities

- Conducting research on Environmental and social policy issues with various government and international agencies and training public officers
- To conduct research on Climate Change Policies at the county level e.g Climate Change Funding mechanisms and Participatory Climate risk assessments
- Development of training programs on County Climate Change Funding Mechanism under Financing Locally Led Climate Actions project
- Development of research and grant proposals for research and consultancy services in Environment and Social Risk Management.

- Development and rollout of training programs on Environmental governance, Social Risk Management in Infrastructural Development, Environmental Management systems, Climate Policy planning and Formulation, County Climate Change Funds and Green growth and Circular Economy
- Coordination of training programs in Climate change as well as monitoring and reporting the progress
 - Organize Knowledge exchange fora, workshops, seminars on Green Growth, Climate change and Environmental Sustainability,
- Facilitate/train climate change programs and Green Growth to public services to achieve mainstreaming of Climate actions and Green Growth at the counties,
- Development of data collection tools and analysis of data for improving service delivery and for policy development,
- Conduct outreach programs to the public on Climate change and environmental management,
- Provision of consultancy services on policy document development on Environment and Social Risk Management in Development Projects,
- Foster partnerships and collaborations in Environmental Governance, Climate change and Sustainability,
- Build capacity of public officers on research project,
- Supervise research projects to offer guidance and leadership to participants attending management training in the aspects of Environmental governance and natural resource management.

PREVIOUS WORKING EXPERIENCE

Employer: Kenya Forestry Research Institute

2017 January- October 2019: Officer in Charge Turbo Sub- regional Centre (Administrative and Management Responsibility).

Workstation: Turbo.

DUTIES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

- Development of Risk based integrated Environmental and Quality Management Systems (ISO 9001:2015) and (ISO 14001:2015)
- Conducting, monitoring and updating KEFRI's management risks and developing mitigation measures
- Conduct training on Environmental Governance and Environmental Impacts assessments to Senior Management Course (SMC) Participants
- Supervision of SMC participants in policy research related to Food security, environmental Governance, climate change or forest policies
- Implementation monitoring and reporting on Strategic plan 2013-2018.
- Conducting literature review on Phytoremediation by woody tree species in Africa.
- Planning and designing forest research project on Tree breeding for Adaptation to effects of climate change
- Implementation of the planned research activities

- Conduct detailed literature review and field work monitoring the effect of climate change on tree seed production and advice national seed center on the trends that will inform the National strategy for climate change adaptation
- Conduct research on rehabilitation of degraded lands for climate change adaptation and water towers rehabilitation (Cheranganyi and Mt.Elgon)
- Develop dissemination materials including guidelines, journal papers and policy briefs Sub-center administration to ensure smooth running of research activities Implementation of Quality standards for implementation of all programmes within the sub- center
- Provision of technical mentorship to research officers and technical staff

2017- 2019 - Project on the conflicts arising from tree planting on farms due to competing land uses

The aim was to analyze the nature of conflicts, competing interests, their impacts and their resolution mechanisms under competing land use systems

Duties and responsibility

- To plan research on the project and select sites and methods
- To conduct qualitative and quantitative research
- Do data analysis using mixed methods
- Preparing technical Reports and presenting the Findings at FLARE 5th Meeting conference and IUFRO 2019 Conference in Curitiba.

2018 Jan- Sept 2019 - Project collaborator of the National Research Project: Titled Domestication of *Terminalia brownii* tree for adaptation to the effects of climate change; improvement of livelihood and Rehabilitation of Degraded Lands.

- Selection of Tree species that are adapted to dry condition for drought tolerance
- Conducting the socio-ecological survey on the Tree species
- Setting up experiments to evaluate the performance of the species in different ecological zones.

Employer: Southeastern Kenya University (SEKU)

October 2016- December 2016:Part-time lecturer

Workstation: Kitui

Roles and Responsibility

- Preparation of course materials on Dry lands Forestry
- Teaching Dry lands Forestry to third- and fourth-years students
- Preparing and administering continuous assessments and final exams
- Organizing for field excursions and field practical on Dry land forestry

Employer: University of Copenhagen,

March 2015- June 2015: Research associate ship in Sokoine University, Tanzania (Thesis project).

Workstation: Denmark and Sokoine University in Morogoro Tanzania-

Title: The role of local Knowledge in Community forestry: The case of Miombo woodland, Tanzania

The study evaluated the community-based approach on reducing forest degradation. The study also compared the effectiveness of Participatory Forest management in enhancing community livelihood and reducing forest restoration.

Duties and Responsibility

- Community based forest management policies, Participatory Forest Management
- Evaluated the effectiveness of policies meant forest rehabilitation to reduce emissions like community forest management policies developed to arrest forest degradation and improve livelihood in Iringa, Tanzania

- Presentation on Research findings on Conferences and seminars

Employer: Kenya Forestry Research Institute (KEFRI), Kitui

2010-2013: Assistant Research Officer

Workstation: Kitui, Drylands Eco-region Research Program, Kitui

Duties and Responsibility

- Development of forest research proposals on Breeding of Dryland Species for adaptation to climate change
- Conducting dry land forestry experiments physiological work for development of drought tolerant tree species as a way to adapt to the impacts of climate change
- Dissemination of research Findings through agricultural shows, Consultative forum and conferences

Projects Involved in

- Financing Locally Led Climate Actions-World Bank Funded-Training of County officers
- Kenya Devolution support programme-World Bank funded-Training of County officers
- Science and Power for Forest Management (Scifor) –master’s Thesis Project
- Development of drought tolerant tree species for adaptation to climate change (*Melia volkensii* and *Acacia tortilis*) –JICA Funded
- Domestication of Indigenous Dryland trees such as *Terminalia brownii*, *Osyris Lanceolate*-National Research Fund, Government of Kenya (Gok)
- *Melia volkensii* and *Vitex Payos* for climate change adaptation, Food security and improvement of Livelihood –GoK
- Eco-physiological Assessments of Dryland Tree species- Japan International, Forestry Promotion and Cooperation (JIFPRO)
- Ecological impacts of Invasive species-*Prosopis juliflora*

CONSULTANCY ASSIGNMENTS UNDERTAKEN

2022 February-September 2022 - Case studies on Drought Management in Kenyan Arid and semi-arid Areas-Assignment undertaken for IUCN

- Interpreted Terms of References informed by a theoretical underpinnings of Nature-based Drought management.
- Undertook literature review and consultative meetings for potential sites of study
- Designed questionnaires
- Undertook field work (Key informant Interviews)
- Make presentation to the end users to inform policy in drought management in Kenya
- Investigated the land restoration measure of indigenous Maasai community under the REDD+ project in Protected National Parks

December 2023: Conduct Training to Makeni county on County Climate Change Fund Mechanism, Climate Finance, Carbon Market, for County Climate change Planning Committee.

2021-2022 : Development of Strategic Plan for Centre for Environmental governance and climate change for The Kenya School of government

- Conduct Capacity Needs assessments based on the national, international and county climate change policies
- Conduct stakeholder mapping and analysis
- Conduct Situational Analysis on Environmental governance and climate change for school and public needs.
- Engage stakeholders on their contributions to the strategic plan through workshops and interviews
- Undertake SWOT Analysis of the Centre
- Develop the strategic direction based on the visions of the school
- Develop the strategic objectives and activities of the Centre
- Develop strategic maps and matrix of the Centers strategic objectives.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIP

Forest Society of Kenya – FSK/F/0454

Lead Expert _Environmental Impact assessments

LEADERSHIP POSITIONS HELD

- Assistant Regional Director Turbo Forestry Research Sub- centre January 2017 to October 2019
- Youth Wildlife and Environment Movement 2006-2009-Treasurer
- Environmental Management representative (EMR) for Research and Development section head ISO: 14001 in KEFRI- 2011--2019
- Project management of Government funded research projects Indigenous fruit tree

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS AND PUBLICATIONS

- 1) **Bala, P.**, Ojunga S. O., Okumu, J., Kisiwa, A., Langat, D., & Nyambati, R. (2020). Tree-based conflict management mechanism among small landholders in agroforestry systems of Kenya. *East African Journal of Forestry and Agroforestry*, 2(2), 24-39.
- 2) **Bala, P.**, Langat D., Okoth, S., Okumu, J., Joshua Cheboiwo, J., Abdalla Kisiwa, A., Nyambati R., (2019) Tree- Based Local Mechanisms Among Small Land Holders In Agroforestry Systems of Kenya. Online Paper presented at XXV IUFRO WORLD CONGRESS 29th September to 5th October 2019 I Brazil, Curitiba.
- 3) Luvanda, A. M., Kamau, C. N., Uchi, S. M., **Bala, P.**, & Okeyo, M. M. (2019). Domestication of *Terminalia brownii* among smallholder farmers in Eastern Kenya: a double hurdle approach.

- 4) Bala, P., Gitchi, G., Vincent, O., Omondi, S. F., Albert, L., & Okeyo, M. (2017). Effect of seasonality, graft type and scion characteristics on propagation of *Vitex payos* in the drylands of Kenya. *Journal of Horticulture and Forestry*, 9(6), 49-58.
- 5) Giathi, G., Kitheka, E., Kiama, S., Sheikh, M., **Bala, P.**, Githiomi, J., & Macharia, E. (2016). Tree species composition and diversity in areas of high charcoal production in Kitui County: A case in Ikutha and Mwingi sub-Counties. In *Proceedings of the National Conference on Sustainable Land Management*.
- 6) **Bala, P.**, Langat D., Okoth, S., Okumu, J., Joshua Cheboiwo, J., Abdalla Kisiwa, A., Nyambati R., (2019) Local Mechanism Of Managing Conflicts Among Small Land Holders In Agroforestry Systems of Kenya Paper presented at the 5th FLARE Meeting Ann Arbor Michigan University USA.
- 7) Muturi, G. M., Poorter, L., **Bala, P.**, & Mohren, G. M. (2017). Unleached *Prosopis* litter inhibits germination but leached stimulates seedling growth of dry woodland species. *Journal of Arid Environments*, 138, 44-50.
- 8) **Bala P.A.** (November, 2015). The role of Local Knowledge on Community Forest Management: The Case of Kidunda Kiyave Community Forest, Miombo Woodland, Tanzania. In Books of abstract Challenges of global resource Management-Social, Environmental and Economic dimensions. Poster presented at the annual ELLS Scientific students conference Prague Czech University of Life Sciences, Czech Republic (pp70)
- 9) Bala, P.A. (2015) The Potential Role of Local Knowledge on Community Forest management: The Case of Kidunda Kiyave Miombo woodland, Tanzania (Unpublished Master's Thesis). University of Copenhagen, Denmark
- 10) Kamondo, B., Giathi, G., Osore, C., Machua, J., Kagunyu L., Wafula. A., Bala P., Njuguna J. Wakori S., Maingi F., Nyingi K., (2014). Growing east African Sandal wood: Guideline For tree Growers.
- 11) Muturi G.M., Poorter, L., Godefridus M.J., Mohren and **Bala, P.** (2012 June). *Prosopis* litter inhibits germination and stimulates seedling growth of dry woodland species Paper Presented at the 25th IUFRO-FORNESSA REGIONAL CONGRESS (Kenya) ICRAF, Nairobi

INTERESTS, ACHIEVEMENTS, AWARDS AND GRANTS

- 1) 2021_DANIDA grant for Denmark Alumni Event of Knowledge and Experience Sharing workshop on Green growth and Circular Economy Workshop n Collaboration with Ministry of Environment and Forestry and Kenya School of Government
- 2) 2020 Won DANIDA Scholarship on Short Course training in Green Growth, Climate Change and Environmental Sustainability
- 3) 2018 -FLARE Conference Travel Grant to US Michigan University Conference in Ann Arbor, Michigan August 2019
- 4) 2019_DANIDA grant for Denmark Alumni Event and Open Day in KEFRI- Together with Florence Gathoni And Margaret Miano won the 2018/2019 DANIDA grant from Alumni Event in March 2019

- 5) 2017- Together with other team members, won a National Research Funds Grant (A Multidisciplinary Research grant) Title: Domestication of *Terminalia brownii* for improvement of Livelihood, Adaptation to climate Change and Rehabilitation of Degraded Drylands of Kenya (Awarded by The Government of Kenya).
- 6) 2015 O.H F og A.J.E Heilmans Fond Travel grants for Thesis research work in Tanzania DANIDA Travel grants - For field work and research permit in Tanzania
- 7) 2013- Won Erasmus Mundus Sustainable Tropical Forestry Programme Scholarship to study in University of Copenhagen and In University of North Wales, Bangor. 2010- Award Egerton University Vice Chancellor's list of honor of Academic Excellence during the Graduation in 2009.
- 8) 2002- Awarded a certificate of the most disciplined student in High School.
Project Management: Successfully manage annual budget to the tune of USD30,000 /Year
- 9) Consultancy work on the development of Nzoia Management plan
- 10) Implementation of Environmental Management systems: ISO 14001 in KEFRI
- 11) Mammal census - Lake Nakuru national Park
- 12) Flamingo/Bird count-Lake Bogoria National Park
- 13) Community Environmental Clean-Up Activities_ River Njoro
- 14) Tree planting organized by Egerton university Youth Wildlife Environment movement around Mau complex area

REFEREES

Will be contacted upon request